

vertiGrOwTh!!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 660 September 2003 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club soirees are at Turnbull House,¹ on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar² at 6.30pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30pm for a catch up. Meetings, run by political pundit extraordinaire, "love rat", and charming chairman Nigel Roberts, start at 8.00pm with club business. Talks commence at 8.01pm.



Section night: September 1st: **By popular demand: Short Talks Night!**

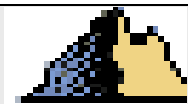
Section Members tell us what they have been up to recently!



Chris, Alan and Matt show off their new skills from AIC 2003! (phwoar, that wind must be strong!)

¹ On Bowen Street, squashed behind the Treasury on Number 1 the Terrace.

² On Molesworth Street, opposite Parliament.



Section nights: Upcoming:

October 6th Lydia Bradey: Hold your breath!

The first woman to climb Mt Everest without oxygen (i.e. holding *her* breath) gives us an insight into why people have found Mongolia such a beautiful destination.

November: Phil Castle

Yep, they named Castle Hill and Castle Rock after this guy! Tales of some serious rock climbing action in Patagonia (the region, kiddies, not the clothes) and other exotic parts like El Capitan, Bhagirathi III in India, yadda, yadda.



Sayonara Kurosawa...ciao Fellini...au revoir Depardieu! The Banff Festival of Mountain Films comes to Wellington!!!

"Well of course the Banff Mountain Film Festival is one of the greatest, if not THE greatest film festival on mountaineering matters in the world"

-Sir Edmund Hillary

Well, if Sir Ed says so.....

On September 5th the New Zealand Alpine Club is bringing this festival to Wellington for the first time. Featuring films on climbing, exploring, and mountain culture, the evening will have lots of variety for the outdoor film lover. Included in the nine films, which range in time from 2 to 52 minutes, will be an adventure in the mountains of Papua New Guinea, a base jump off the north face of the Eiger, and a fascinating look at Himalayan culture. Be prepared for lots of adventure, humour, and adrenalin.

When: Friday Sept 5th 7:30pm

Where: Memorial Theatre, Victoria University

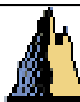
Tickets: \$15.00 available from Mountain Designs, Mainly Tramping and Bivouac

Only 375 seats! Don't miss out!

Thanks also to our other sponsors Fergs Rock 'n' Kayak, Hangdog Climbing Centre, and Format Printing for helping us bring this event to Wellington.



39 Mercer Street, PO Box 1560, Wellington, New Zealand
Ph/Fax (04) 4735353 email mainly.tramping@paradise.net.nz



Section trips news: *Growing and sowing*

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories, tall or short, fat or thin, sharp or dim. We love to know what you're up to!

Re. Peat, Pinnacle performance

On the weekend of 19-20 July four hardy souls went ice climbing on the pinnacles... Terrence Handscombe, Andrew McKinlay, Paul McCullagh and Mike Peat thought sitting on cold cramped ledges in the middle of winter sounded like a good time. It's worth pointing out for the uninitiated that the actual ice climbing component of going ice climbing is minimal compared to the time spent sitting uncomfortably, stretching impossibly, cursing expletively and digging hopefully (for anchors).

The objective was to take a group of enthusiastic climbers of intermediate ability and expose them to the thrills (and hopefully not spills) of multipitch technical ice climbing. The trip clearly sounded so formidable that 5 climbers were forced to withdraw before we left Wellington. The survivors enjoyed a lovely stroll up to the hut on a still and starry Friday night.

After an alpine start on Saturday morning good ice conditions were found on the Pink Floyd Buttress. Momentary Lapse of Reason (3 pitches) and Comfortably Numb (2 pitches) were climbed along with several forays up to the skyline of the upper pinnacle ridge by various ridges and gullies before dragging ourselves back to the hut upon nightfall. On Sunday another alpine start was welcomed with grim resignation. The Moonshine Buttress was explored and the first pitch of Chiming Bells was all but climbed before having to back off due to thin unstable ice. A few small waterfalls in the Valley area were top roped before heading home.

All in all a successful trip was had with marvellous weather throughout and good company enjoyed. Waterfall ice has not formed well this season but the alpine ice / mixed climbing is pretty good so go and enjoy it while it lasts.

Mike



Shed 6 Queens Wharf
Wellingtons Waterfront
Ph 04 4998898 Fax 04 4998896
wn@fergskayaks.co.nz
www.fergskayaks.co.nz

Open 7 Days

Largest Real Rock Indoor Rock Wall – Kayaking – Inline Skates - Retail - Rental

Alpine Club Members with card can climb anytime for \$8.
Monday nights show your members card and climb for \$5.



New Zealand Alpine Journal 2003: Contributions please!

Contributions sought... Yup — it's that time of the year again; time to put pen to paper, fingers to keyboard and start sorting out those slides.

We want *your* words and photos. Principally we seek reports of this year's most note-worthy climbs (either new climbs or repeats), articles or essays from any aspect of the greater sphere of climbing, local area reports, and yes... obituaries. As always photographs and artwork are welcomed.

If you have an idea you wish to discuss or any questions, or a submission, don't hesitate to contact the editor:

Mark Watson – NZAJ Editor
(day) 03 377 7595, (eve) 03 942 3312
editor@alpineclub.org.nz
PO Box 786, Christchurch.

CLOSING DATE 1st SEPT 2003



OCEANS OF FURY – Grapes...No, Mountains of...of...WRATH: Adventure Philosophy Kayak and Mountaineering adventure in Tierra Del Fuego

Venue: Lecture Theatre 1, Government Buildings. Opposite the Cenotaph in Lambton Quay.

When: Friday 7.30pm September 12 2003.

How: By pre-purchased tickets \$12.00 or students \$10.00 from Mainly Tramping 39 Mercer Street Wellington.

Prize Draw: Of a new MSR stove, drawn on the night.



Our website

- Check out our web site: www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz !
- Join the email discussion group!
- New photos and trip reports up!



CHAIRPERSON'S QUIZ No. 3: Answer

The chairperson's third quiz question (Who am I?) saw a record number of entries; all were correct. The answer to the question was Matthias Zurbriggen. (For those flummoxed by the V15 problem, the "A"s in the riddle were Aconcagua, Argentina, Aoraki, and Aotearoa.)

The name of the winner, John Barnes, was drawn by Dick Price at the August section meeting, and -- as a result -- Barnsy from Palmy has been given a bottle of wine from a country beginning with A (Argentina actually, though some thought he deserved wine from Albania).

The Editor also thanks John Barnes who, in his excitement about having the right answer, in his eagerness to win, and in his misconception that the Editor was the person to respond to, PHONED THE EDITOR AT 6.30 AM ON SUNDAY MORNING to provide the correct answer. Nice one John! Let me make this clear - all answers to the chairman, who is Nigel Roberts!!!



Gotcha! Our "Love Rat" CHAIRPERSON'S 4th QUIZ QUESTION: It's reigning Royals!

In June the section chairperson told members about his close personal association with Princes Di (just like James Hewitt, selling his shabby story to the tabloids, in this case Vertigrowth. Love rat! Ed.). Nigel's fascination with royalty clearly continues unabated, because his fourth quiz question is:-

During the last century, a reigning monarch was killed in rock climbing accident. Who was it; which country was the monarch from; when did the accident happen, and was a conspiracy involving the CIA responsible?

Email your answers (with the phrase "Quiz number 4" in the subject line) to <chairperson@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz> by midday on Sunday, 31 August 2003.

Our esteemed chair also pointed out that 31 August is the sixth anniversary of the death of Princess Di ...:-)



MOVED HOUSE?

Tell:

Richard Wesley, NZAC Administrator
PO BOX 786
CHRISTCHURCH
TEL (03) 377 7595, FAX (03) 337 7594
e mail office@alpineclub.org.nz



NZAC National Instruction Programme

Course Numbers are limited so book early! Fully qualified alpine guides or rock instructors will be used to lead all courses and there will be an instructor - student ration of 1:4 ensuring an excellent learning environment.

Intermediate Alpine Instruction (Two Days) \$130

2-3 August Mt Ruapehu

Intermediate Rock Instruction (Two Days) \$99

23-24 October, Otago

1-2 November, Canterbury

23-24 October, Auckland

1-2 November, Wellington

Intermediate- Advanced Mountaineering (Five Days) \$950

3-7 January 2004, Unwin Hut Mt Cook

10-14 January 2004 Unwin Hut Mt Cook

Richard Wesley, National Administrator

Phone: 03 377 7595

Email: richard@alpineclub.org.nz



Canyoning and First Aid courses: 15% NZAC discount

CanyonZ Ltd is running a Wilderness First Responder Course for the first time in NZ. Located in Auckland, the 7-day course is a worldwide-recognised course that trains participants to respond to emergencies in remote settings.

The WFR title is THE qualification to have if you are an outdoor guide in the USA (or if you are looking at working there), or if you wish to acquire a very complete First Aid qualification. It is more complete and more outdoor-focused than a standard two-day outdoor first aid course or a Pre-Hospital Emergency Care (PHEC) course.

Places are limited. Location: Auckland. Registration deadline: 7th September. For more info call 0800 422 696 or email info@canyonZ.co.nz.

Canyoning level one course

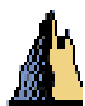
4 days from 25th September to 28th September

This course is a great opportunity to learn the proper canyoning techniques and it is also the first step towards working as a canyoning guide or assistant guide. It is suited to people with basic knowledge of knots, abseiling and anchors. Topics covered will include risk management and safety, anchors, canyoning specific knots, rigging and abseiling techniques, whitewater, and a lot more!

The first 2 days of the course will involve canyoning, the last 2 days will be dedicated to specific canyon rescue techniques.

The added benefit of the level one course is the presence of Dave Black, who is an ACA (American Canyoneering Association) certified guide and instructor. He will be observing and teaching the course and will warrant cross-crediting to ACA level one. The ACA is the only training organisation for guides in the USA and offers cross-crediting to European organisations.

Places are limited. Location: Auckland. Registration deadline: 7th September. For more info call 0800 422 696 or 0800 462 965 or email info@canyon.co.nz.



Respected club contributor dies

Well known Club supporter and honorary member (since 1986) Joan Johnson passed away recently, in Wellington. Joan, along with her husband Neville, who passed away 2 years ago, was a great worker for the Club and assisted Neville, who was the Club secretary for many years, in administering the Club. She was a warm and delightful person. Joan's family recently kindly donated Neville's NZAC Journals to the NZAC.



And here are the club trips...

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, come and chat to Mike Williams (trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email me, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and I can help you get going on a safe and enjoyable trip.

See you in the hills!

Fare thee well our Alpine Trips Coordinator!



This month the Committee farewelled Jenny Henshaw, our Alpine Trips Coordinator, who has had to leave us and return to her native Christchurch for employment reasons. Thanks for a great job Jenny and we wish you well and success in the future!

Trips currently on the calendar...

Ruapehu Alpine Style!!	<i>Weekend August 30-31</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Mike Peat, email: mike.peat@xtra.co.nz , 04 479 5521 (h)	
Access the bush edge via 4WD from the south, climb the spur to the west of the Wahianoa River, camp on the Glacier and traverse Girdlestone, Tahurangi and Mitre. Suitable for last years AIC students or anyone who hasn't explored this remote part of the mountain. A good level of fitness is required.	

Girdlestone	<i>Weekend September 20-21</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Alpine, Various	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Dave Shanks, email David.Shanks@wcc.govt.nz	
The plan is to split into small groups and do various activities (weather and conditions dependent), e.g., North ridge of Girdlestone/South West face of Girdlestone (technical route), Tahurangi summit, ice-fall climbing, snow boarding or skiing, or the climbing wall at National Park! The trip will be based at Matai Lodge in Ohakune.	

Wharepapa Rock Climbing	<i>Weekend October 4-5 (note change)</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock Climbing	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> Mike Williams, email mw@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A weekend away rock climbing at Wharepapa in the central North Island.	

Arthurs Pass / Castle Hill Exploration	<i>Long Weekend October 25-26-27</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock / Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> Mike Williams, email mw@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A trip with everything, the plan involves a mix of rock climbing at Castle Hill and Flock Hill, and day trips with mountaineering objectives such as Rolleston, Phipps, or possibly a 2 dayer to Franklin. Details depend on ambitions and abilities in the group. Trip to be based at NZAC hut in Arthurs Pass Village.	

Aoraki / Mt Cook National Park	<i>Long Weekend October 25-26-27</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Kevin Patterson userkev1@netscape.net	
A trip with everything, the plan involves a mix of rock climbing at Castle Hill and Flock Hill, and day trips with mountaineering objectives such as Rolleston, Phipps, or possibly a 2 dayer to Franklin. Details depend on ambitions and abilities in the group. Trip to be based at NZAC hut in Arthurs Pass Village.	

Paynes Ford	<i>Weekend November 8-9</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> Steve Hart, email sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A weekend to the top-o-the-south, rock climbing at Paynes Ford.	

Tasman Saddle	<i>Week November 29- December 7</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Mountaineering	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Caroline Duggan, email cd@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz Garth London, email gl@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
Already full! If interested get your name on the waiting list soon!	

Hopkins Valley	<i>Week January 3 – 11, 2004</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Mountaineering / Rock	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Steve Hart, email sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
A week away from the tourist hoards, exploring this great area just south of Cook/Aoraki, with tramping and easy summits through to cragging and snowy mountains.	

Taranaki Rock Trip	<i>Long weekend January 17-18-19</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Rock Climbing	<i>Level:</i> All
<i>Organiser:</i> TBC email rocktrips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	

Nepal	<i>TBC</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Overseas Expedition	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Steve Hart, email sh@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz	
How about a slightly longer trip to Nepal in Oct/Nov 2004? *Update* : Interest steadily grows. With the changing regulations so too do the objectives, one of which is to scale Mt Have-a-Good-Time. Trekking options will be part of this trip. We'll be aiming to stay away from the Everest circus while still utilising the ease of logistics. One of our goals will be an unclimbed peak up to 6500m. If you are interested and willing to be part of a team effort contact Steve.	

Chile	<i>TBC</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Overseas Expedition	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Toto Gronlund, toto.high@ntl-world.com	
The English alpine club are organising a trip to Patagonia in 2004.	



HANGDOG INDOOR CLIMBING CAVERN

Come down and see us for all your climbing and bouldering needs. We have heaps of good routes from grade 14 through to 30. We have the only bouldering room in Wellington, which we have just enlarged to help aspiring and existing climbers become STRONGER.

Remember that it only costs NZAC members \$8.00 to climb with ID, and you get 20% off all climbing gear that you purchase from us. If we don't have what you want we will get it.

HangDog and Top Adventures
453 Hutt Rd
Lower Hutt
(04) 589 9181



For sale...wanted...climber partner needed

For sale: Asolo plastic alpine boots and Black diamond foot fang crampons to fit, \$200 the set, ice hammer and short axe, \$75 each, snow pig and snow stake, \$20 each. All good condition. Phone Simon 382 8836 hm 916 3847 work.

WANTED: Plastic mountaineering boots in good condition, all sizes.

Phone Kate or Mike on 03 7534 099, PO Box 4, Franz Josef Glacier, South Westland. Phone 03 7534 099, e-mail westcoastclimbing@xtra.co.nz.

Ski tour or climbing partner wanted!: 1st - 19th Sept and 6th - 31st Oct for short or long trips. 8 years climbing experience and now trying my hand at ski touring. Please leave a message with contact number. Steve (Christchurch) 03 3775034, steven_jeff@yahoo.com



Do you have a great photo?

Good enough for the cover of vertiGO? The send it to:

cd@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Wellington Section Directory: 2003 contact list

Please notify the Club' s National Administrator of your change of address as the labels for all newsletters and club publications are generated at the HQ office. You can contact:

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Patron	Judy Reid	N/A	N/A
Chairperson	Nigel Roberts	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> NR	(04) 475 7543
Vice Chairpersons	Pete De Joux	PDJ <i>or</i> PD	(04) 478 1017
	Steve Hart	SH	N/A
Secretary	Rachael Schmidt	SECRETARY <i>or</i> RS	(04) 470 4479
Treasurer	Caroline Duggan	TREASURER <i>or</i> CD	(04) 475 5542
<i>National Representative</i>	Caroline Duggan	CD	(04) 475 5542
Instruction: AIC	Pete de Joux	AIC	(04) 478 1017
Instruction: RIC	Scott Taylor	SPRINGROCK	N/A
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Trips: Rock	Mike Williams	ROCKTRIPS <i>or</i> MW	(04) 973 2995
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
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	Michele Domaneschi	MD	N/A
	Garth London	GL	(04) 479 2984
	Alan Lowrie	AL	N/A
	Mike O' Brien	MOB	(04) 380 0913
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
	Mike Williams	MW	(04) 973 2995
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Section Night Admin	Kara Lipski	KL	N/A
Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz